

The Crowbar of Versailles

The legend of the cold iron crowbar is a frightening tale of madness with extreme consequences. Towards the end of World War I, a French Dauntain believed that he could rid the world of the Near Dreaming and the “demons” that ruined his life. While it’s unknown how he succeeded, he managed to smuggle the crowbar into the Dreaming. The two forces clashed and the Near Dreaming, and every fae, were destroyed along with huge areas on the mundane plane.

While the Near Dreaming began healing, it took the Resurgence to fully restore it into a healthy, but scarred, area. If the crowbar survived the explosion, its whereabouts are unknown.

The simplest way to picture the Dreaming is to consider three layers, each a different plane, that surround the world. In turn, each plane consists of vast numbers of Dream Spheres that host entire landscapes, nations, freeholds, homesteads, or sometimes just a simple witch’s cottage where a mystery awaits. The only way to travel between the spheres is through the use of trods (p. 307), but the further one travels between the planes, the rarer and more unstable the roads become. Kithain named the planes the Near, Far, and Deep Dreaming.

For the better part of 600 years, the Dreaming and its ancient lands were truly out of changelings’ reach, but the Resurgence changed this. Now it’s a place ripe for exploration and rediscovery. Despite the dangers, the desire to explore the Dreaming is deeply rooted in Kithain culture. In these ancient realms, lost freeholds, treasures, and mythic lore exist. Somewhere, in the furthest reaches beyond the Deep Dreaming, stand Arcadia’s gates, waiting to be rediscovered.

The largest threat to Kithain survival is the plane itself. Due to its nature, the Dreaming is antithetical to the Banality that exists on the mundane plane. Once Kithain enter certain areas of the Dreaming, they’re subjected to a slow process of purification that eventually brings imbalance to their relationship between Banality and Glamour. All changelings know this, but many ignore it. The Dreaming brings out the strongest faerie nature in them, causing the sensation of freedom from the mortal coil.

Dream Mechanics

Entering the Dreaming alters the nature of changeling characters, improving their capacity to wield magic and strengthening their faerie nature. This entails changes to the game system depending on the plane. Switching between planes replaces the previous alterations; when entering a new plane of the Dreaming, regardless of whether the character is getting closer to or further from the Autumn world, the rules for that plane are the only ones that apply.

Time, Travel, and The Dreaming

Time works differently in the Dreaming compared to the Autumn world, but it’s not as simple as saying that one minute in one world equals one hour in another. Time simply passes at a different and fluid rate. It’s possible to enter a trod in North America, go on a journey that seems to take decades, and depart the Dreaming in Scandinavia minutes after leaving the starting point in the mundane world.

History is full of folktales and legends detailing how mortals go missing only to reappear decades later as if no time passed at all (or go missing for a short period of time, and come back decades older).

Banality Purification System

Once changelings pass beyond the Vale of Mists (see the Far Dreaming), the Dreaming’s purified Glamour begins to cleanse its visitors of the burdens that the mundane life puts on their shoulders. While this purification eventually reduces the Banality pool to 0, all changes done to the Banality rating only count for the duration of the stay in the Far and Deep Dreaming. Nonetheless, not even in this situation can the Banality rating drop below 1. Changelings remain tied to their mortal coil no matter how hard they try to escape it.

Characters decrease the Banality pool by one point per day until it reaches 0. Following that, provided that the character is active in the Dreaming — going on quests, interacting with the natives, exploring, etc. — one dot of Banality breaks down into 10 points after a week, after which the character begins the process of losing one point per day again. This makes it possible for even the most Banality-ridden to eventually enter the Deep Dreaming, provided they successfully survive the many challenges and impressions of the chimerical world.

Once a character leaves the Far Dreaming, the Banality rating returns to what it was upon entry. Only legendary Treasures and quests (p. 271) can remove Banality dots.

Near Dreaming

The following rules apply while in the Near Dreaming.

- ☉ It’s easier to cast cantrips while in the Near Dreaming. The base difficulty (p. 194) changes to 7.
- ☉ Anything chimerical becomes solid and fully tangible in the Dreaming, including chimerical companions, voile, and the miens of changelings.
- ☉ The Dreaming makes no distinction between chimerical damage (and death) and physical death. A changeling that suffers either form of death in the Dreaming dies, their soul passing on to a new incarnation (or, in the case of Arcadian sidhe, disappearing for parts unknown). For someone with an anchor in the Autumn world, death means that the physical body falls into a coma and wastes away.
- ☉ Kithain entering Bedlam while traveling on trods turn into one of the Onus — fae intent on defending the pathway against future wayfarers.
- ☉ Mortals entering the Dreaming bodily obey its laws. Death inside the Dreaming is a great problem, since the Banality